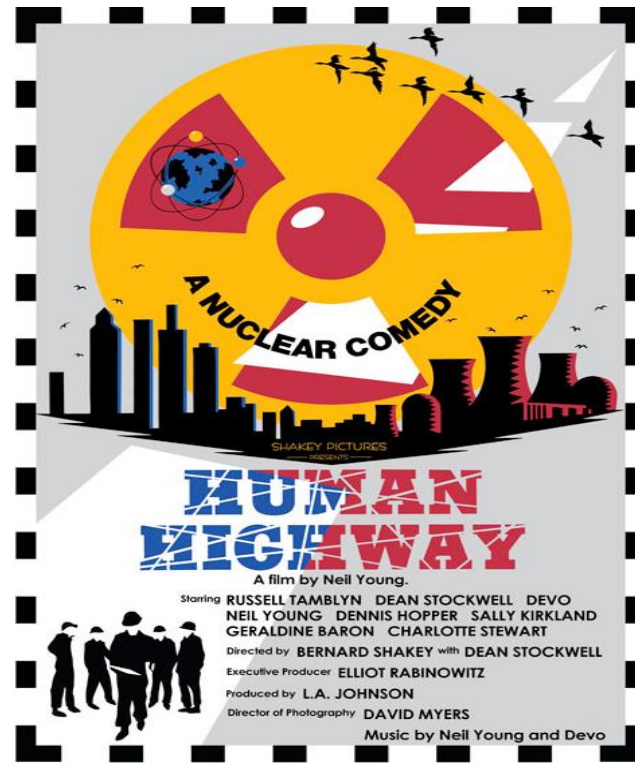


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As of September 25, 2014

HUMAN HIGHWAY: Director's Cut
Toronto International Film Festival 2014



HUMAN HIGHWAY: Director's Cut

September 14, 2014
Colton Eddy Blog

COLTON EDDY
Producer, Writer, Music Journalist.


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TIFF 2014: 5 things we learned from Neil Young's forgotten film, Human Highway

September 14, 2014 at 11:25 pm • Posted in WEB by Colton Eddy



Bernard Shakey, a.k.a. Neil Young, welcomed a **Toronto International Film Festival** audience this week into a director's cut screening of one of his most wild, forgotten visions: 1982's Human Highway.

HUMAN HIGHWAY (Director's Cut) Trailer | Festiv...  



Nearly three decades after its short-lived initial release and a limited laserdisc release, Human Highway still holds strong today as an anarchic satire of Cold War America's complacency. The cast includes the late Dennis Hopper, Dean Stockwell (who also co-directed the film), Russ Tamblyn, Charlotte Stewart and the members of Devo. It's another example of Young's most experimental decade, reflected in the synthetic soundtrack: as if "the machines were singing to them," as Young said at the film screening.

Human Highway was recently recut and restored, depicting a band of complacent townies in Linear Valley, with Young as a nerdy auto mechanic and Hopper playing a volatile cook. Their valley sits next to a nuclear plant, and they are ignorantly living their last day on Earth.

During the post-film Q&A at TIFF, which was moderated by the festival's artistic director, Cameron Bailey, Young explained the process of achieving his vision with a film that was once described as "the Wizard of Oz on acid." He unravelled some stories and facts that are sure to earn some stellar Uncle Neil trivia points at your next Crazy Horse-themed cocktail party...

[Read the full original post on CBC Music](#)

<http://www.coltoneddy.com/tiff-2014-5-things-we-learned-from-neil-youngs-forgotten-film-human-highway/>



September 13, 2014

Risky Fuel

Human Highway: Kevin Costner Was A Janitor On The Set Of The Neil Young Film



Neil Young

Classic rocker and film dabbler recently presented a director's cut of his rather weird 1982 film *Human Highway* at this year's Toronto International Film Festival. Young, who was in attendance for the premiere, told the audience at the screening about working with Devo for the film as well as a special behind the scenes role played by future star Kevin Costner. To read the story head over to Huffington Post Music Canada by going [here](#).

<http://www.huffpost.com/2014/09/n-neil-young-tiff-large300.jpg>

<http://riskyfuel.com/2014/09/13/human-highway-kevin-costner-played-a-janitor-in-the-neil-young-film/>



September 13, 2014

Pitchfork - Neil Young Re-releasing 1982 Film *Human Highway*, Announces Bridge School Benefit Lineup

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ROLLOVER TO WATCH



Neil Young Re-releasing 1982 Film *Human Highway*, Announces Bridge School Benefit Lineup

Film starring Young, Devo, Dennis Hopper, and Russ Tamblyn

By **Evan Minsker** on September 13, 2014 at 10:30 a.m. EDT

 102  126  +1



In 1982, **Neil Young** released a film that he co-directed, co-wrote, and starred in. *Human Highway* is a weird one, to say the least—an apocalyptic comedy that also features Devo, Dennis Hopper, Russ Tamblyn, Dean Stockwell, Sally Kirkland, and others. The film, which includes several songs from his synth-centric album *Trans*, got premiered at the Mill Valley Film Festival in 1982 before getting released on VHS and LaserDisc in the '90s.

After screening at the **Toronto International Film Festival** alongside a talk from Young, the film is getting re-released, *Billboard* reports. The newly restored and recut *Human Highway* will open at New York's Film Forum in January and then get a wide release. Watch the new trailer below.

The film was largely self-funded by Young. "It was ridiculous to explain it and we had no script that we could point to to say, 'This is worth hundreds and thousands of dollars,' so finally we just made it, just rented the place for a month or so," Young told the TIFF crowd. Read more quotes from Young about the film [via Billboard](#).

The lineup for Young's annual **Bridge School Benefit**, which will take place from October 25-26 at the Shoreline Amphitheatre in Mountain View, has also been announced. Young, Pearl Jam, Soundgarden, Florence + the Machine, Tom Jones, Band of Horses, Norah Jones, and Pegi Young are all scheduled to play. Find full details [here](#).



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It's the first concert to feature both Neil and Pegi Young since it was reported last month that the couple had [filed for divorce](#). The Youngs co-founded the Bridge School in 1986.



<http://pitchfork.com/news/56685-neil-young-re-releasing-1982-film-human-highway-announces-bridge-school-benefit-lineup/>



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September 12, 2014

CBC Music - TIFF 2014: 5 things we learned from Neil Young's forgotten film, Human Highway

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HUMAN HIGHWAY: 5 NEW FACTS

Sep 12, 2014

TIFF 2014: 5 things we learned from Neil Young's forgotten film, Human Highway

Article posted by Colton Eddy

Bernard Shakey, a.k.a. Neil Young, welcomed a [Toronto International Film Festival](#) audience this week into a director's cut screening of one of his most wild, forgotten visions: 1982's *Human Highway*.

HUMAN HIGHWAY (Director's Cut) Trailer

HUMAN HIGHWAY TRAILER

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Nearly three decades after its short-lived initial release and a limited laserdisc release, *Human Highway* still holds strong today as an anarchic satire of Cold War America's complacency. The cast includes the late Dennis Hopper, Dean Stockwell (who also co-directed the film), Russ Tamblyn, Charlotte Stewart and the members of Devo. It's another example of Young's most experimental decade, reflected in the synthetic soundtrack: as if "the machines were singing to them," as Young said at the film screening.

Human Highway was recently recut and restored, depicting a band of complacent townies in Linear Valley, with Young as a nerdy auto mechanic and Hopper playing a volatile cook. Their valley sits next to a nuclear plant, and they are ignorantly living their last day on Earth.

During the post-film Q&A at TIFF, which was moderated by the festival's artistic director, Cameron Bailey, Young explained the process of achieving his vision with a film that was once described as "the Wizard of Oz on acid." He unravelled some stories and facts that are sure to earn some stellar Uncle Neil trivia points at your next Crazy Horse-themed cocktail party.

We've wrapped them up in five points, for easy learning.

	AUDIO Listen to the TIFF Q&A here, recorded from Colton Eddy's seat in the Elgin & Winter Garden Theatre.
---	---

1. Young on Kevin Costner: 'He was like a janitor or something'

When breaking down who the crew was from the film — which was mainly funded with his own money between 1978 and 1981 — Young and Stewart casually mentioned that a worker named Kevin Costner was "in charge of taking care of the studio." Both Young and the Academy Award winner would be linked a few years later on *Dances With Wolves*, as two of the domesticated buffalos in the film were borrowed from the man who had formerly been part of Buffalo Springfield.

2. Devo had a massive influence on post-1977 Young

After he caught Devo's gig at West Hollywood's Starwood Club, Young cast the group in his film as nuclear waste workers who sang a parody of the traditional folk song "[Worried Man Blues](#)," which had been popularized by the likes of the Carter Family, Johnny Cash and Pete Seeger. (Side note: that's Young's former partner/collaborator Pegi Young as the biker woman.)

When filming began, Young was writing a handful of songs that eventually resulted in "[Rust Never Sleeps](#)." It's a title that came directly from the logo on a pair of underpants that Devo's Mark Mothersbaugh's alter ego, Booji Boy, was wearing during their jam session (printed when the band worked at a local Rust-Oleum to raise money for their film *The Truth About De-Evolution*). With Booji Boy in his baby crib, they jammed an unrehearsed chord progression that became "[Hey Hey, My My](#)," which was included as part of a dream sequence in *Human Highway*.

3. Jean-Luc Godard was also a big influencer

As well as collaborating with new wavers Devo, Young said he found inspiration in the work of Jean-Luc Godard, the French-Swiss director often recognized as the new-wave film movement master:

"The original [film] was designed on purpose to be very slow. I really liked Godard and I loved watching these long shots just unfold. I would drag the beginning. If there was any frames, as soon as the camera was up, I would just start using it and then I would just go right to the end of the shot until it ended, so everything is real slow and I was laughing my ass off because I thought it was really funny with all these dorky, stupid people talking to each other real slow. I thought it was hilarious, but nobody else did."

4. Lionel Switch: origins of a model train fascination

Young is somewhat of a [model train geek](#), and he released a [limited set](#) based on his album *Greendale*. Today, Young is a co-owner of Lionel, LLC, a Michigan-based designer and importer of model trains and railroads. In *Human Highway*, Young recalled how he named his character after the company with which he had just started:

"I was getting involved with Lionel trains at the time, developing some technology for them for their digital command control and sound systems and had a company going with the owner of one of the trains and had a development going on with a bunch of the engineers and everything, so my name in the movie was Lionel Switch."



5. Young as Bernard Shakey

We know him best for his incomparable musical creations, but Young has occasionally taken on the role of filmmaker — and when he does, he uses the pseudonym Bernard Shakey. Young took this rare opportunity to offer a glimpse into that headspace:

"I wanted it to look like a storybook, so that people could realize that there was nothing real about it and the only time it got real was when Lionel was dreaming and the rest of it was just a set and that was something I wanted to do and the cinematography, I liked directing the shots and coming up with real long tracking shots and have a lot of things going on because I used to really enjoy some of the home movies that did that and still do. Then we worked on the script, we'd know what we were going to do, we knew what the scene was about and we knew what was going to happen in the scene but we didn't have any dialogue until the morning of the scene when we would write the dialogue."

<http://music.cbc.ca/blogs/blogpost.aspx?modPageName=&year=2014&month=9&title=TIFF-2014-5-things-we-learned-from-Neil-Youngs-forgotten-film-Human-Highway&permalink=/blogs/2014/9/TIFF-2014-5-things-we-learned-from-Neil-Youngs-forgotten-film-Human-Highway>



September 12, 2014

Deadline Hollywood – Toronto Beefs Up Premieres; Expect...Neil Young

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tiff. toronto international film festival

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The 39th Toronto International Film Festival added another seven Galas and 17 Special Presentations to its September fest lineup running September 4 to 14. Here are the newcomers:

...

Human Highway (Director's Cut) Bernard Shakey and Dean Stockwell, USA World Premiere

The road to the '80s is reflected through the hi-tech, fantasy lens of Neil Young's 1982 film, *Human Highway*. This absurdist comedy-musical deals with one of the most serious issues of our time: the threat of nuclear destruction. Starring Dean Stockwell, Neil Young, Devo, Russ Tamblyn, Dennis Hopper, Charlotte Stewart, Sally Kirkland and Geraldine Baron.

<http://deadline.com/2014/08/toronto-festival-schwarzenegger-travolta-adam-sandler-817904/>



September 12, 2014

Toronto Star – Neil Young Hits Human Highway

TORONTO STAR
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Obvious Best Picture nominees are hard to pin down at TIFF this year, but the nominations for Best Actor and Actresses are easier to predict. Among the surest bets, clockwise from top left, Jennifer Aniston, Benedict Cumberbatch, Reese Witherspoon, Julianne Moore, Eddie Redmayne and Bill Murray. Julianne Moore stars in *Maps to the Stars*.

Neil Young hits Human Highway

Canadian rock legend revisits his future shock satire filmed in 1982

PETER HOWELL
MOVIE CRITIC

The characters are dorks, the script is a joke and the special effects are as cheesy as radioactive cheddar in *Human Highway*, Neil Young's 1982 apocalyptic satire.

Yet the message is a serious blast against complacency, and it's as valid now as it was 32 years ago, the Canadian rocker and occasional filmmaker told a TIFF audience Wednesday night at the Elgin Theatre.

"There are so many things that we all see and we just live with," said Young, 68, following the TIFF world premiere of the restored "director's cut" of *Human Highway*.

"So now I think it's time to not do that, and just start really making some noise."

Human Highway was originally billed as a "nuclear comedy" when it had its erratic release in 1982, mainly at film festivals, before largely vanishing from view thanks to withering critical and audience reaction.

Set in a remote hick town called Linear Valley, which is dangerously close to an ominously glowing nuclear plant, it stars Young as bucktoothed and bespectacled auto mechanic Lionel Switch, who lives a life of care-free ignorance.

"We're all a little dorky," Young said of himself and his castmates.

When his pal Fred (Russ Tamblyn) mentions to him the deadly effects of radiation, Lionel replies he's repaired "almost every radiator in every car in town" and never suffered any ill effects.

Little do Lionel and Fred know; but Linear Valley is about to be blasted from the face of the Earth, something we can guess from the bumbling incompetence of the "nuclear garbage persons," played by members of the New Wave band Devo, who do a lousy job of handling the nuke plant's radioactive debris.

The bright reddish-orange jumpsuits worn by the workers, adorned with safety hats with tubes pumping oxygen directly into their nostrils, aren't that different from the outfits that Devo would wear on stage.

At one point, Lionel adopts a rock star pose and jams with Devo on Young's tune, "Hey Hey My My (Out of The Blue, Into The Black)." There are a few other songs in the film, but *Human Highway* couldn't really be described as a musical.

All anybody seems to care about in town is how money-grubbing diner and gas bar owner Otto (Dean Stockwell) wants to jack up prices and reduce portions of the breakfast special, which is cooked by a chef played by the late Dennis Hopper.

"It's just the big picture of complacency and just how people saw everything but they just kind of dealt with it as being a part of reality," said Young, whose songs and public statements often protest social ills.

YOUNG continued on E7



CHRIS PIZZELLO/INVISION/THE ASSOCIATED PRESS
Rocker Neil Young arrives at the director's cut premiere of 1982's *Human Highway*.

<http://torontostar.newspaperdirect.com/epaper/viewer.aspx>



September 12, 2014

94.7 WCSX Detroit's Classic Rock - Neil Young Debuts "Human Highway: The Director's Cut" At TIFF

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Classic Rock News > Neil Young Debuts "Human Highway: The Director's Cut" At TIFF

Neil Young Debuts "Human Highway: The Director's Cut" At TIFF

Posted on 9/12/2014 10:01:00 AM by Gary Graff



Neil Young has returned to the big screen — and returned to one of his fabled big screen projects.

Young debuted "Human Highway: The Director's Cut," a restored and spruced up version of his 1982 apocalyptic comedy, on Thursday (September 11) at the Toronto International Film Festival. Young stars in the low-budget film, playing a car mechanic who pines for a waitress played by Charlotte Stewart (Young's soon-to-be-ex-wife Pegi, in fact, was a waitress when they met). Actors Dean Stockwell, Dennis Hopper, Russ Tamblyn, Pegi Young and members of Devo also appear in the film, while the soundtrack includes songs from Young's electronic-flavored 1982 album "Trans" as well as "Hey Hey My My (Into the Black)" and a bizarre version of Bob Dylan's "Blowin' in the Wind" sung by Devo's Booji Boy.

Young told the TIFF audience that he had to self-finance "Human Highway" because "it was ridiculous to explain it and we had no script that we could point to to say, 'This is worth hundreds of thousands of dollars,' so we finally just made it, just rented the (soundstage) for a month or two."

"Human Highway: The Director's Cut" will be shown once more, during January at the Film Forum in New York, before being released to theaters and then, presumably, as a home video.

Meanwhile, Young will be releasing a symphonic album called "Storytone" on November 4, while he's been recently linked romantically to actress Daryl Hannah after paparazzi photos surfaced of the two in Westlake, Calif. Young filed for divorce from Pegi, his wife of 36 years, during August.

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Human Highway Press Clippings, Page 12



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<http://www.wmgk.com/gmi/classicrocknews//2014/09/12/neil-young-debuts-human-highway-the-directors-cut-at-tiff>



September 11, 2014

Huffington Post - Neil Young Talks 'Human Highway' And Set Janitor Kevin Costner At TIFF

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Neil Young Talks 'Human Highway' And Set Janitor Kevin Costner At TIFF

The Huffington Post Canada | By Sarah Karchak

Posted: 09/11/2014 4:39 pm EDT | Updated: 09/11/2014 4:59 pm EDT

HUMAN HIGHWAY (Director's Cut) Trail

HUMAN HIGHWAY TRAILER

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Over three decades after Neil Young first unleashed his bizarrely visionary nuclear apocalyptic musical about societal complacency, the singer/songwriter/actor/director came to TIFF to debut a brand new director's cut of "Human Highway" on Wednesday night.

The original cut, which never managed to score much of the way in distribution when it was made in 1982 and exists mainly on worn bootleg VHS copies, is a beloved rarity in the greater Neil Young oeuvre. It's so hard to come by that even some of his most devoted fans admitted that they hadn't seen the film in years and had to ask Young what was different about the new version

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'80s Rock Stars, Then And Now

in a post-show Q&A with the Canadian legend and members of the cast.

"It's quite a bit different. The original was designed on purpose to be very slow. I really like [French New Wave film icon Jean-Luc] Godard and I love to watch his long shots unfold," Young, clad in a black t-shirt that read "EARTH" and a backwards baseball hat told the audience. "So everything was really slow. I was laughing my ass off because I thought that was really funny with all of these dorky stupid people talking to each other really slow and I thought that was hilarious, but no one else did."

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▶ Despite the punchier pace, though, Young's message remains the same.

"It was a big picture of complacency and just how people saw everything, but they just kind of dealt with it as being part of reality and no one ever really questioned what was going on," Young said. "It's not really nuclear power or anything like that. It's just more all of those things kind of at once. There are so many things that we see and just live with, so now I think it's kind of time to not do that and just

start really making some noise."

Gerald Casale of Devo, who play a large role in the film, expressed similar sentiments about its meaning to him both then and now. "I had no idea that Neil felt the same way about the big human condition that Devo did. That was a revelation. And that's why it's relevant. Nothing's changed. The human highway leads to a drop off like the Road Runner."

He also expressed how much of a difference "Human Highway" made for Devo. "For me, it was kind of life-changing because Devo was fresh and green from the midwest and our whole lives changed overnight. I had directed three low-budget Devo videos and that was about it, and then suddenly I find out Neil Young likes us, and we get to meet him. And I grew up listening to Neil Young and after the shootings at Kent State [the event that inspired Young's "Ohio"], I used to lay around in my apartment and listen to "After The Goldrush." And suddenly I was getting to write and block out a five-minute piece with Devo as disgruntled nuclear waste workers in Linear Valley," Casale.

Devo weren't the only artists who enjoyed some sort of big break thanks to "Human Highway." After thanking and praising all of the filmmakers and actors involved in the picture, Young wanted to take a moment to thank one particular member of the clean-up crew.

"The guy who we were talking about taking care of the set... what was his job?" he asked his castmates on stage.

"You mean Kevin Costner?" laughed actress Charlotte Stewart.

"Yes," Young confirmed. "He was like our janitor or something."

"He was on the set every day," Stewart added. "He learned everything he knew from Neil."

Producer Elliot Rabinowitz, who was somewhat reluctantly pulled out of the crowd to participate in the Q&A, contributed some important details about the way "Human Highway" was made.

"Neil wrote a lot of it as we progressed. I know that's probably impossible to tell that," he laughed, lovingly teasing the film's eccentric and loose plot structure. "But there

was a lot of improv."

In that same playful tone, Rabinowitz blamed The Man for keeping "Human Highway" down all of these years. "It was actually very, very anti-establishment when we did it, and that's probably the reason why we couldn't get any distribution. It couldn't have been the film. Obviously politics played a great deal."



Leonard Cohen On New Album And Smoking Again Now That He's 80



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September 11, 2014

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TIFF: Neil Young hits the Human Highway again to blast complacency

The characters are dorks, the script is a joke and the special effects are as cheesy as radioactive cheddar in *Human Highway*, Neil Young's 1982 apocalyptic satire.

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CHRIS PIZZELLO / CHRIS PIZZELLO / INVISIONAR

Rocker Neil Young arrives at the director's cut premiere of *Human Highway*, which he made and co-starred in in 1982.

By: Peter Howell Movie Critic, Published on Thu Sep 11 2014

The characters are dorks, the script is a joke and the special effects are as cheesy as radioactive cheddar in *Human Highway*, Neil Young's 1982 apocalyptic satire.

Yet the message is a serious blast against complacency, and it's as valid now as it was 32 years ago, the Canadian rocker and occasional filmmaker told a TIFF audience Wednesday night at the Elgin Theatre.

"There are so many things that we all see and we just live with," said Young, 68, following the TIFF world premiere of the restored "director's cut" of *Human Highway*.

"So now I think it's time to not to do that, and just start really making some noise."

Human Highway was originally billed as a "nuclear comedy" when it had its erratic release in 1982, mainly at film festivals, before largely vanishing from view thanks to withering critical and audience reaction.

Set in a remote hick town called Linear Valley, which is dangerously close to an ominously glowing nuclear plant, it stars Young as bucktoothed and bespectacled auto mechanic Lionel Switch, who lives a life of carefree ignorance.

"We're all a little dorky," Young said of himself and his castmates.

When his pal Fred (Russ Tamblyn) mentions to him the deadly effects of radiation, Lionel replies he's repaired "almost every radiator in every car in town" and never suffered any ill effects.

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Little do Lionel and Fred know, but Linear Valley is about to be blasted from the face of the Earth, something we can guess from the bumbling incompetence of the "nuclear garbage persons," played by members of the New Wave band Devo, who do a lousy job of handling the nuke plant's radioactive debris.

The bright reddish-orange jumpsuits worn by the workers, adorned with safety hats with tubes pumping oxygen directly into their nostrils, aren't that different from the outfits that Devo would wear on stage.

At one point, Lionel adopts a rock star pose and jams with Devo on Young's tune, "Hey Hey My My (Out The Blue Into The Black)." There are a few other songs in the film, but *Human Highway* couldn't really be described as a musical.

All anybody seems to care about in town is how money-grubbing diner and gas bar owner Otto (Dean Stockwell) wants to jack up prices and reduce portions of the breakfast special, which is cooked by a chef played by the late Dennis Hopper.

"It's just the big picture of complacency and just how people saw everything but they just kind of dealt with it as being a part of reality," said Young, whose songs and public statements often protest social ills. He was wearing a T-shirt with "EARTH" emblazoned on it.

"A lot of people think about it, they just don't talk that much about it. A lot of people see things that are going on that aren't right, they wish they could change it but they think they can't, because they're told all the reasons why they can't. So they become complacent ... that's what happens when you forget about it."

The 80-minute film plays like an episode of *Corner Gas* as directed by David Lynch, whose *Twin Peaks* TV series would later use two of the cast members from *Human Highway*: Charlotte Stewart (who was at the Elgin screening) and Russ Tamblyn.

"I wanted it to look like a storybook so people could realize that there was nothing real about it," Young said. "The only time it got real was when Lionel was dreaming."

Although he's billed as co-director (with Stockwell), under his filmmaking pseudonym Bernard Shakey, and also as co-screenwriter (the script was mostly improvised by the cast), Young seemed to think of himself more of a cinematographer while making *Human Highway*.

"I liked directing the shots and coming up with really long tracking shots ... I used to really enjoy some of the old movies that did that, and still do."

He tried to imitate his filmmaking hero Jean-Luc Godard in the original version of *Human Highway*, which emphasized long, slow takes. The director's cut is "quite a bit different," Young said.

"The original was designed on purpose to be very slow. I really liked Godard and I loved watching these long shots just unfold ... so everything is like really slow. I was laughing my ass off because I thought that was really funny with all these dorky stupid people talking to each other and really slow (camerawork). I thought that was hilarious, but no one else did!"

Among the crew for the production, which was mainly funded by Young and proceeded in fits and starts from 1978 to 1981, was a worker named Kevin Costner, who would later become known as the actor and director Costner.

"He was like the janitor or something," Young said.

Human Highway was conceived in an era of intense public discussion and protest over the growing use of nuclear energy.

The movie "was actually very, very anti-establishment when we did it," said Elliot Roberts, Young's longtime manager, who was also at the Elgin.

"That's probably the reason we didn't get any distribution. It couldn't have been the film!"



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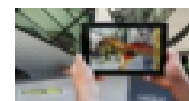
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By Karen Bliss | September 11, 2014 8:08 PM EDT



Neil Young
Michael Klotz, WireImage



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The rocker addressed a Toronto Film Festival audience at 'Director's Cut' premiere.

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"Boy, did I go for a big trip," says Neil Young's character at one point in the film Human Highway, a line that just about sums up the viewing experience of the singer's newly restored and recut 1982 apocalyptic comedy, which he co-directed, co-wrote and stars in. The new version premiered Wednesday night at the Toronto International Film Festival.

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Lafayette Journal & Courier – Neil Young Waves to Fans at Human Highway Premiere

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Star Watch Sept 11



A large photograph of Neil Young at a premiere. He is wearing a black leather jacket over a black t-shirt with a graphic, and a black baseball cap. He is waving his right hand towards the camera. To his left, a woman with short brown hair and a black top is looking towards him. In the background, other people and bright lights are visible.

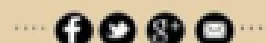
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NEW YOUNG
PUBLISHERS

Nachdem der Film in Kinos lief, sei auch eine Veröffentlichung auf DVD und Blu-Ray geplant. In einem weiteren Interview hat WS Mitchell von Shesky Pictures dem Online-Magazin "Pro Tools Expert" die technischen Hintergründe des Produktionsprozesses verraten.

Bill, King, and Martin

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Neil Young, Elliot Roberts und Filmverleiher Richard Abramowitz:



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Musician Neil Young, star and co-director of the 1982 film "Human Highway," waves to fans as he arrives Sept. 10 at the premiere of the director's cut of the film at the Toronto International Film Festival. (Chris Pizzello / Invision / Associated Press)

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Musician Neil Young, center, star and co-director of the 1982 film "Human Highway," poses with cast members Charlotte Stewart, left, and Gerald Casale, of Devo, at the premiere of the director's cut of the film at the Elgin Theatre during the 2014 Toronto International Film Festival, on Wednesday, Sept. 10, 2014. (Chris Pizzello/Invision/AP)

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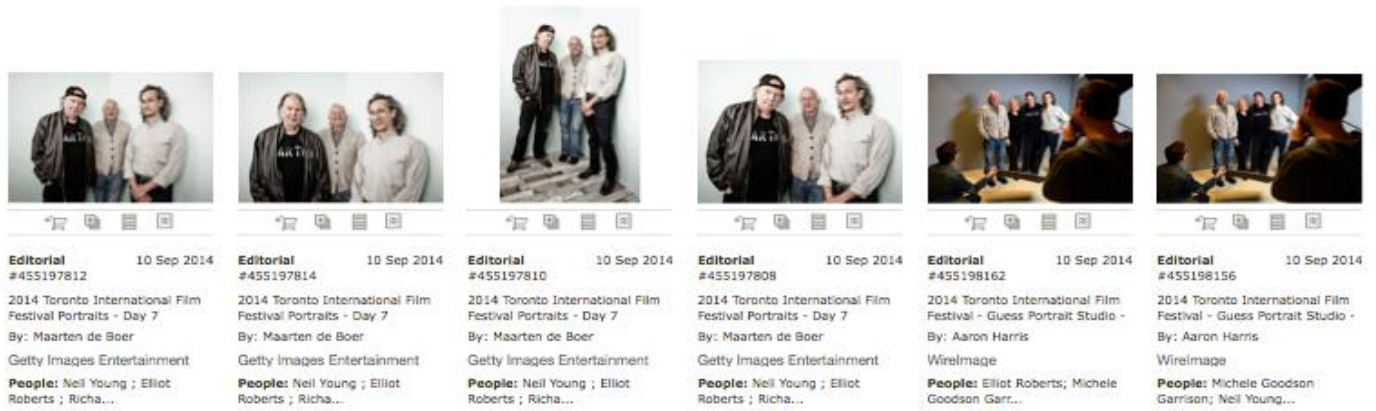


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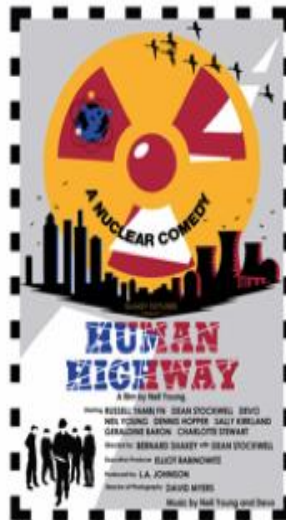
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Human Highway (Director's Cut) – World Premiere at TIFF



Neil Young's 1982 Film Restores Lost Sound & Dialogue using Unique Audio Techniques



September 10, 2014 – Toronto International Film Festival: Shakey Pictures is proud to announce the World Premiere of Human Highway (Director's Cut) at the Toronto International Film Festival today. The director's cut version of Neil Young's mind-bending 1982 post-apocalyptic musical comedy conceived in the cauldron of Cold War America, in which the rock legend writes, directs and stars alongside an eclectic and eccentric cast including Dean Stockwell, Russ Tamblyn, Dennis Hopper and members of the band Devo. Human Highway was painstakingly restored using modern techniques for high quality sound but done without violating the intent of the original sound mix. Restoration difficulty was further compounded by the fact that several of the original masters were missing.

Human Highway – Take One

Production of the film began in the late 1970's and led to an eventual screening at the Mill Valley Film Festival in 1982. However, mixed reactions from the assembled audience of film buffs and music fans gave the producers cause for reflection and they immediately went back to editing, resulting in parts of the movie being strewn about all over the cutting room floor and destined to be forgotten and left behind.

Thus began an epic journey to find the elusive missing footage that would help piece back together their original vision of a possible future. Digging through over thirty years of archives, the team at Shakey Pictures was then tasked with locating, cataloging and viewing every element ever associated with the film in the hopes of finding the masters.

The Quest for Lost Audio

The first step in the search was to identify the master analog multi-track tapes so they could be restored and transferred at high resolution for digital assembly and surround sound mixing. To begin with the highest possible sound quality, the original 2" 16-track multis were converted at 24-bit/192-kHz. However, it was discovered that the music and dialogue tracks were not on separate tracks but rather were already mixed on these master reels.



Montage of the original Human Highway tapes and reels – Shakey Pictures

The team went back in the vaults again to find the 16-track reels with isolated dialogue and music, but other than locating music on 1/4" reels, there was no source material with the master dialogue. So as a final step, the search was on to find the original Nagra reels to get clean dialogue. The dialogue reels were located, and incredibly – the original Nagra IV-S machine was found – the exact same machine that had actually been used on set in 1982. Originally introduced in 1971, the Nagra IV-S recorded two-track stereo. It had dual level pots, limiters, and equalizer presets and was considered the highest quality in its time.

With the tapes and the reels in hand, each Nagra reel had to be reviewed to locate the exact takes that were used for the film. There were then transferred to high resolution so that the post-production process could begin using the best sounding and cleanest sources. "As I listened through boxes of Nagra reels, I really felt like a fly on the wall of the set" said Will Mitchell of Shakey Pictures "Often tape was rolling wild both before and after takes, so I got to experience the process and understand just where the crew was in capturing the master performances. As with many films, the improvised lines on alternate takes were incredibly creative and fun. It was clear that this was a fun shoot."



"Worldizing" Re-Mixing Technique

A unique audio technique - called "Worldizing" - was applied to scenes for the Director's Cut. Rather than applying a plugin or an effects processor to flat or dry audio, Shakey Pictures used Worldizing to give the sound great depth, dimension and realism by playing the audio back in a suitable acoustic space and then re-recording it. This resulted in real world ambience and reflections, something that digital production can only approximate. Some examples of Worldizing can be heard inside the garage at Otto's Corner, during the radio broadcasts and in some of the music. These Worldized tracks were also used as a blended effect to create the foundation for post-production.



Neil Young as "Lionel Switch" riding a stationary bike against a surreal backdrop, an example of the film's "hyper-real sets." - Tom Keogh Review at IMDb.

Surround for Climactic Dream Sequence

Once in post-production, one of the major challenges of mixing Human Highway was dealing with all the separate elements. Because it was mixed so long ago, it was difficult to find the pieces all in one place. Quite often each mix would start with a partial stem with dialogue and effects and music all mixed together. Then, later in the workflow, the effects and music were mixed together, but the dialogue separate and isolated.

But this was not always the case; often the discreet stems would have just dialogue and no effects and music, or just effects and no music and dialogue and so on.

It was a significant and time consuming effort to equalize and blend multiple sources into a seamless track. "Working with all these sources was very much like an Easter-egg hunt", said Tamara Johnson, Sound Designer & Re-recording Mixer of Post-Apocalyptic Studios. "The goal was to make the film's 'Linear Valley' setting seem very normal - although was far from it! So to lull the audience into this normalcy, the background mix is stereo and dialogue and effects, mono. No panning was used, the sound is pure and comes straight up the middle into the audience."

The film then builds up to the climactic scene when Neil Young's character "Lionel" suffers a bump on the head and drifts into an intense 'dream sequence' that sees Lionel become a rock star and performs a ten-minute studio jam scene where Young and Devo play together.



Neil Young and Devo in Human Highway's Dream Sequence - Shakey Pictures

Now that the audience is conditioned to the stereo/mono effect, the goal was to shock them by introducing new sound elements for this dream sequence. The objective was to make Lionel's dream sequence 'huge' using surround elements with wide and isolated channels swirling around the room. "We tried to make this scene larger than life", said Johnson. "It was vital to have a high quality surround mix with no phasing or delays so I used Penteo to upmix backgrounds and music into 5.1 Surround for this pivotal dream sequence".

The crowd surround elements were mixed around the room, effectively placing the viewer in the middle of the scene so that the audience becomes 'Lionel' for that intense moment. The film closes when Lionel wakes up and finds himself back in 'normal' Linear Valley - the dream is a fantastic contrast to reality.

About Shakey Pictures

Shakey Pictures, founded in 1972 by Bernard Shakey has over 40 years filmmaking to its credit and has produced such memorable titles as "Journey Through The Past", "Rust Never Sleeps", "Human Highway", "Solo Trans", "Muddy Track", "Weld", "Year Of The Horse", "Silver and Gold", "Greendale", "CSNY/Déjà vu", "Heart Of Gold", "Trunk Show" and "Journeys". For more information see the official Toronto International Film Festival Website: <http://tinyurl.com/pmowaj6> or our website: <http://tinyurl.com/ncfn2yu>.

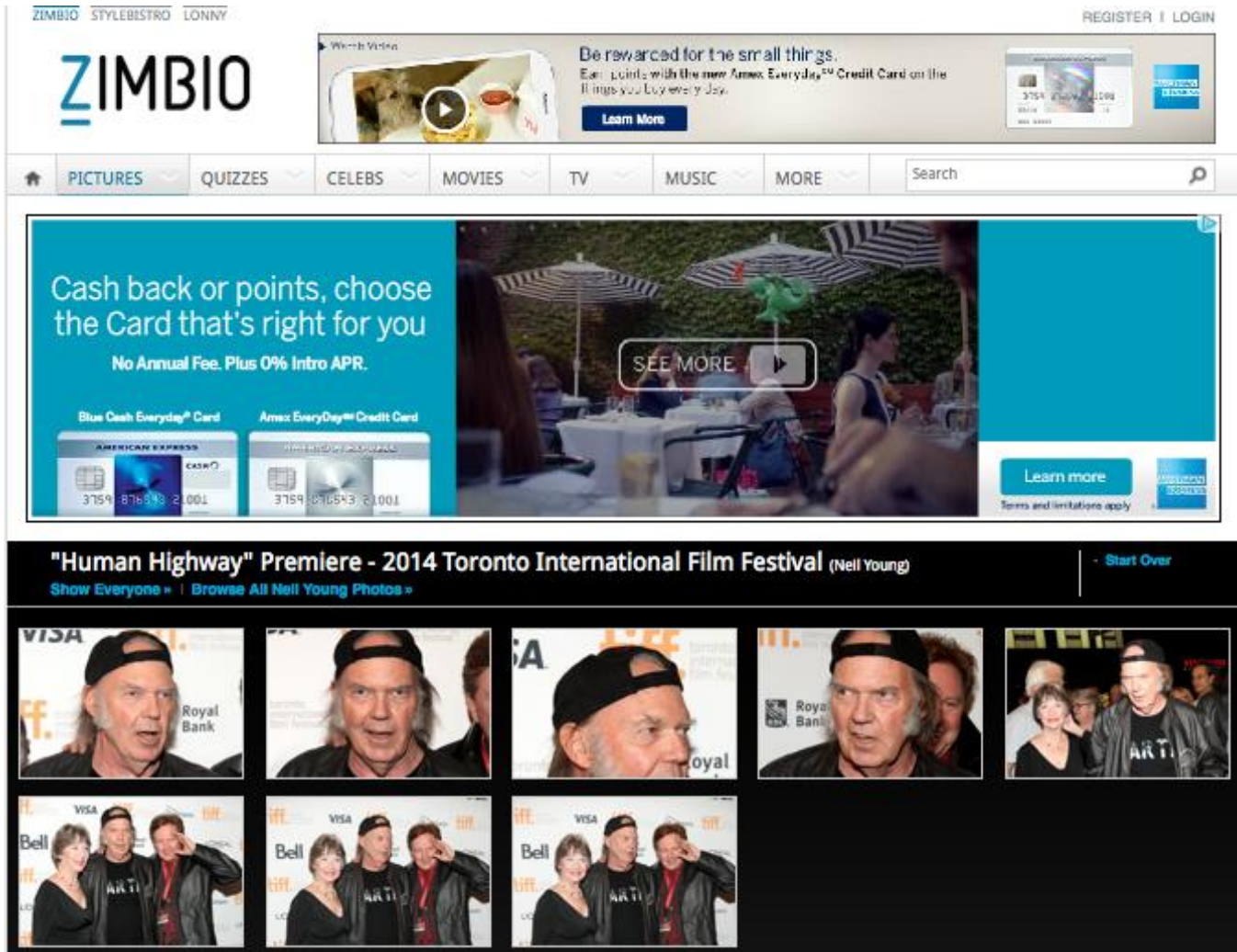
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Penteo transforms any stereo recording, soundtrack, DJ mix or live television broadcast into perfect 5.1 surround sound. Developed by Audiotech Digital Limited, Penteo remains faithful to the original stereo mix; no artificial sound manipulation is used. The Penteo plug-in creates a perfect surround experience for all stereo media with zero sonic artifacts, crisp and discrete center-channel, and only Penteo is 100% ITU down-mix compatible to the original stereo. Penteo has been used by major studios on hundreds of films, TV shows and music recordings and supports AAX64, RTAS, VST and AU formats. For more information, see our website <http://www.perfectsurround.com>

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September 10, 2014

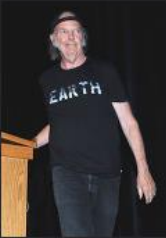
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September 10, 2014

Pro Tools Expert

THE STORY OF THE AUDIO RESTORATION OF NEIL YOUNG'S HUMAN HIGHWAY TO THE ORIGINAL DIRECTOR'S CUT



Once described as "The Wizard of Oz on acid," Human Highway was Neil Young's mind-bending 1982 post-apocalyptic musical comedy film conceived in the cauldron of Cold War America, which the rock legend wrote, directed and starred alongside an eclectic and eccentric cast including Dean Stockwell, Russ Tamblyn, Dennis Hopper and members of the band Devo and may also be the secret origin of The Simpsons.

Human Highway was first screened in 1982 at the Mill Valley Film Festival to mixed reviews which caused the producers to and over the intervening 30 years the sections that hit the cutting room floor in that recut have gone astray.

So Shakey Pictures decided to see if they could find all those missing bits and rebuild the film as writer, director and star Neil Young originally envisioned it. However restoration very quickly proved to be problematic and was further compounded by the fact that several of the original masters were missing.

The team had to dig their way through over thirty years of archives, cataloging and viewing every element ever associated with the film in the hopes of finding the masters.



They found some 2" 16 track analog masters which were transferred to 24 bit at high resolution but it became clear that music and dialog were not on separate tracks and despite extensive searching they were unable to track down the master dialogue tapes.



16 track transfer underway

So as a final step, the search was on to find the original reels to get clean dialogue. The dialogue reels were located, and incredibly - the original Nagra IV-S machine was found as well - the exact same machine that had actually been used on set. Now the team had to identify the exact takes that were used in the film, transferred at high resolution and painstakingly rebuilt the dialog tracks. Will Mitchell from Shakey Pictures described the process...



“ As I listened through boxes of Nagra reels, I really felt like a fly on the wall of the set” said Will Mitchell of Shakey Pictures “Often tape was rolling wild both before and after takes, so I got to experience the process and understand just where the crew was in capturing the master performances. As with many films, the improvised lines on alternate takes were incredibly creative and fun. It was clear that this was a fun shoot.



The actual Nagra IV-S

With all the different parts to the puzzle, some fully mixed, others partly mixed and others using the original source takes it was a challenge to bring them all together to produce a seamless mix and this task fell to Tamara Johnson, Sound Designer & Re-recording Mixer of Post-Apocalyptic Studios. I managed to catch up with Tamara and my first question was to ask here how she handled this enormous needle in a haystack.

TJ - When the tapes first arrived it was like walking into a room full of treasure. There was boxes and boxes and it really makes you appreciate that now you can put everything on a thumb drive compared to sometimes needing a fork lift to get everything in.

But the real hard work was done by Will at Shakey Pictures and it was monumental what they did. They went to Chace Audio in Burbank and they pulled everything together into a massive Pro Tools session at 96K/24 bit and got everything in sync and presented to me. Then I had to go through and sort it all out, because sometimes dialog was in the clear and sometimes it wasn't. Sometimes music was in the clear and sometimes it wasn't. Normally my aim when you are mixing is always to have pristine tracks ready for foreign language versions, but in this case that wasn't possible because so many of the elements were mixed together.

It's a fun experimental movie and the more you work on it, the more you like it, the more you find yourself quoting it. In fact the guys I am working with will often close an email with a line from the movie.

The goal was to make the film's 'Linear Valley' setting seem very normal - although it was far from it! So to lull the audience into this normality, the background mix is stereo and dialogue and effects, mono. No panning was used, the sound is pure and comes straight up the middle into the audience.

None of it was digital so it had a lot of noise on it and I would need to match the sound very carefully. For example I could have a line that would be clean from the Nagra and then it would go right into a full mix.

MT - Wow, so a lot of eq matching?

TJ - Yes I would use a lot of my favourite plug-ins like the DMG Equality. I also used the Sonnox Restore suite to get rid of the noise, as well as the McDSP Noise Filter. Neil is very fond of a process called Worldising?

MT - What exactly is that process?

TJ - It's wonderful, for example if you have something that is playing on a radio then he plays it on a radio and records it. This way he has got the room environment exactly the way he wants it. Since then I have adopted it, I have thought well I could just record this myself, so I will put something on my iPhone, get in my car, play it in my car and record it in my car.

MT - And so get the sound through the speakers with the car acoustic all in one hit.

TJ - Exactly, it seems old school but it sounds really good.

MT - Moving onto the surround element in the film, was the whole film reworked into surround using the Penteo Pro 4 Surround plug-in or was it just for the dream sequence in the film?

TJ - It was only the dream sequence. At first I thought great, let's put the backgrounds in surround and so on but I changed my mind. I wanted to keep the whole movie simple sounding and faithful to the original mix. But the film builds up to the climactic scene when Neil Young's character "Lionel" suffers a bump on the head and drifts into an intense 'dream sequence' that sees Lionel become a rock star and performs a ten-minute studio jam scene where Young and Devo play together.



I wanted to make Lionel's dream sequence 'huge' using surround elements with wide and isolated channels swirling around the room. We tried to make this scene larger than life and it was vital to have a high quality surround mix with no phasing or delays so I used Penteo to upmix the backgrounds and music into 5.1 Surround for this pivotal dream sequence". I wanted it to feel like we were inside Neil's head, effectively placing the viewer in the middle of the scene so that the audience becomes 'Lionel' for that intense moment. The film closes when Lionel wakes up and finds himself back in 'normal' Linear Valley making the dream is a fantastic contrast to the reality.

MT - So did you use different instances of Penteo for the different elements?

TJ - Yes, I Penteoised my different sound effects individually, so instead of a 2 track sound effect I had a 5.1 sound effect track and mixed all of those together and it really makes it, so you go wow when the explosion happens and you go into his dream. In fact I think that was the word that Neil used when he first heard it.



It was a huge challenge to work and in fact I have described it as an easter egg hunt. It was a wonderful experience and I am very happy with the way it turned out and I am so excited that they are in the Toronto Film Festival.

MT - The premiere of Neil Young's Human Highway (The Director' Cut) is tonight at The Toronto International Film Festival.

Many thanks to Tamara for taking the time to share with us this very interesting and challenging project working for such an iconic artist who always strives for the highest quality.

<http://www.pro-tools-expert.com/home-page/2014/9/10/the-story-of-the-audio-restoration-of-neil-youngs-human-high.html>

September 9, 2014

Neil Young News - Q&A on Human Highway Director's Cut

Neil Young News

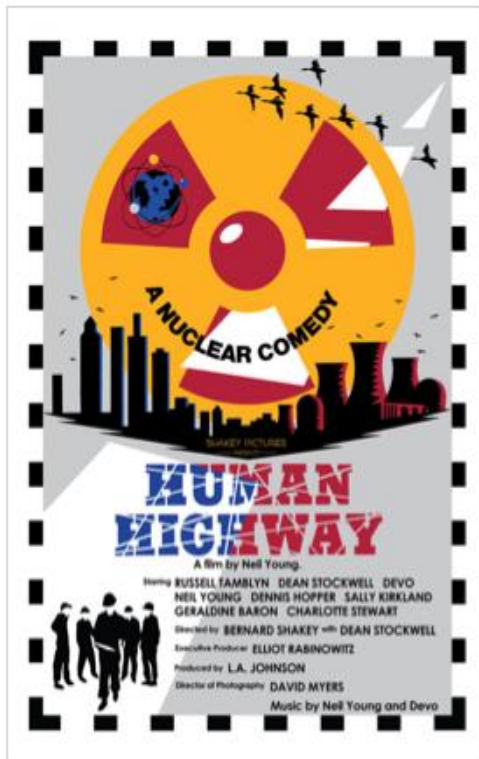
An unofficial news blog for Neil Young fans from Thrasher's Wheat with concert and album updates, reviews, analysis, and other Rock & Roll ramblings. Separating the wheat from the chaff since 1996.



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TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 09, 2014

EXCLUSIVE: Q&A on Human Highway Director's Cut



This week, the World Premiere of Human Highway (Director's Cut) will be held at the Toronto International Film Festival.



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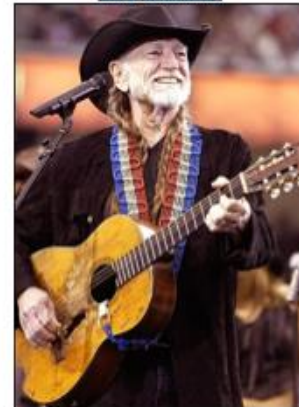
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Thrasher's Wheat is pleased to bring our readers an exclusive Q&A session with a member of Neil Young's Shakey Pictures crew who worked on the research, editing and meticulous restoration under the supervision of Director Bernard Shakey.

Neil Young's 1982 post-apocalyptic musical comedy, has long been out of circulation and is regarded as a cult classic with its mythical history of production mayhem, post-production chaos and forgotten legacy.

Now, 32 years after *Human Highways*' first screening, Bernard Shakey's crew is ready to answer a few questions.



Thrasher's Wheat - *The film Human Highway is considered to be a cult classic somewhat similar to the legendary Journey Through the Past and has been described as "if David Lynch directed The Wizard of Oz on acid." What surprised you going back to the footage shot back in late 70's?*

Shakey Pictures - *Maybe not so much surprising, but very noticeable was how well shot the film was under the direction of David Myers.*

[ed - David Myers (1914-2004) was the cinematographer for the film *Woodstock* and Martin Scorsese's *The Last Waltz* among many other concert documentaries..]

TW - *So what prompted the desire to produce a director's cut version of Human Highway?*

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TW - So what prompted the desire to produce a director's cut version of Human Highway?

SP - The version that was first screened at the Mill Valley Film Festival in 1982 really could be considered the Director's Cut. Time went on and various edits of the film had their moment in the sun, but Mr Shakey still held onto his original vision. Along with Producer L.A Johnson, he dispatched the Shakey Pictures crew to locate, catalog and collect for assembly all the original footage that had been cut out of Human Highway post- Mill Valley. It was a lengthy undertaking.



TW - The original release of Human Highway was 88 minutes. The director's cut version is 80 minutes. Usually these director's cut versions go to longer side not shorter. Is this tweaking/ shortening up longer scenes or scenes removed?

SP - That is correct. Once the 1982 Director's Cut was reassembled, Bernard oversaw further refinements to the story. An astute viewer will note that while the running time of the movie is shorter than that on VHS, there are actually some new elements in the final presentation that will be screened at TIFF.

TW - Was this filmed in 35mm?

SP - Human Highway was shot in both 35mm and in 16mm film.

TW - What are we looking at now? Film edited on high resolution digital video?

SP - The Shakey Pictures team found and transferred the original negatives of the film footage, which then underwent extensive restoration and cleaning, frame by frame. Editing was in high resolution digital.



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TW - What is the sound format resolution compared to original?

SP - The sound quality is much improved over the original. The same attention to detail that was given to picture was also given to audio on this project.

The film's original master 16 track analog tapes were transferred at 24 bit/ 192kHz, as well as the original dialog and music reels.

The new mix of Human Highway is now presented in 5.1 surround as well as in stereo.

TW - What are the release format plans? Blu-ray?

SP - After Human Highway's theatrical run, it would be fair to say that you can expect to see Blu-ray and DVD releases.



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TW - We know folks would love to hear the story of Woody, the wooden Indian and his mates. Were they really burned in the desert? Is Woody, the wooden Indian, we've seen recently onstage with Neil the same? A survivor?

SP - Yes, that is indeed Woody in the film. He has some scenes in the garage at Otto's Corner. I don't know his back story or what stock he came from, but do know that Woody embodies the strong silent type. That is well depicted in Human Highway.



TW - Will there be a director's cut video release with "special features"? Like a vinyl album soundtrack, a booklet, deleted scenes, 'making of' documentaries, etc?

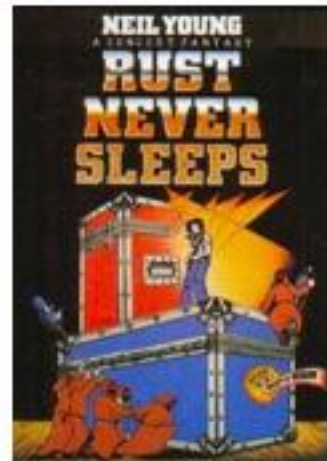
SP - It's a bit too early to reveal what comes next out of the Shakey Pictures archives in relation to Human Highway, but there is definitely some stuff in the vaults.



Thanks Shakey Pictures!



Photo by [Craig Abaya](#)
courtesy of The Bridge School



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[Human Highway \(Director's Cut\) Trailer](#) from [Shakey Pictures](#) on [Vimeo](#).



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September 4, 2014

Uncut - Watch Neil Young's trailer for his new Director's Cut of Human Highway

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NEWS

Watch Neil Young's trailer for his new Director's Cut of Human Highway



Neil Young has released a trailer for the new Director's Cut of his 1982 film, **Human Highway**. Scroll down to watch the trailer.

The Director's Cut is being **screened** at this year's **Toronto International Film Festival**.

On the website for the Toronto festival, the film is described as "a post-apocalyptic musical comedy, in which the rock legend writes, directs and stars alongside an eclectic and eccentric cast including Dean Stockwell, Russ Tamblyn, Dennis Hopper and Devo."

You can find out more information about the screening **here**.

The full line-up and schedule for this year's festival will be announced on August 19.

The festival box office opens on August 31. The festival runs from September 4 - 14.

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Current Issue November 2014

Pink Floyd, Leonard Cohen, New Order and Fleetwood Mac all feature in the new issue of Uncut.



Human Highway (Director's Cut) Trailer from Shakey Pictures on Vimeo.

<http://www.uncut.co.uk/watch-neil-youngs-trailer-for-his-new-directors-cut-of-human-highway-news>

September 3, 2014
Ain't It Cool News



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MOVIE NEWS

Anton Sirius takes a gander at what's playing at the 2014 Toronto International Film Festival!

Published at: Sept. 3, 2014, 8:10 p.m. CST by [Papa Vinyard](#)



Greetings, starkinder! While I have a few spare minutes I wanted to drop a quick preview of the Toronto International Film Festival on y'all before things start to get crazy on Thursday. Having been reviewing films at TIFF for Harry since 2000, and attending the fest since the legendary 1992 year (which saw the birth of the careers of Tarantino, Jackson, Rodriguez and Luhrmann, to name a few) I've become an old hand at...

Wait. Holy crap, I just realized. This will be my 23rd TIFF.

Anyone who's figured out where I get my nom du net 'Anton Sirius' from will understand why that seems significant. I guess I'd better be prepared for miracles and madness, and probably even another dip into the crucible. Nifty.

As per usual TIFF is loaded with films that I need to see, want to see, feel obligated to see and would simply be stupid to miss. My laughably-misnamed-as-always short list this year clocks in somewhere in the 80s out of over 300 features playing during the 11 days of the fest; of those 80-odd I'll probably see a third or so, and that doesn't even account for the films I'll inevitably hear massive buzz about on the ground and have to find a way to work in. If it weren't for the cellular degradation and massive migraines I get after re-integrating all those short term memories, I'd totally clone myself to try and catch them all.

Anyway, here's what caught my eye on this year's schedule:

Wednesday, Sept 10

Mark Ruffalo is a manic-depressive stay-at-home dad in the comic drama *INFINITELY POLAR BEAR*; Viggo Mortensen is a general searching for his runaway daughter through 19th century Patagonia in Argentine auteur Lisandro Alonso's *JAUJA*; a young British soldier is trapped in the wrong part of Belfast during The Troubles in Yann Demange's '71; flipping the '80s sex comedy formula on its head, a teenager desperately tries to lose his virginity to avoid becoming a human sacrifice in *TEEN LUST*; a French survivor of the Khmer Rouge reflects back on his imprisonment in the drama *THE GATE*; a philosophy professor and a small-town hairdresser try to make their impossible relationship work in *NOT MY TYPE*; *INFERNAL AFFAIRS* director Andrew Lau co-directs *REVENGE OF THE GREEN DRAGONS*, a fusion of classic Hong Kong action and gritty New York crime drama executive produced by Martin Scorsese; Neil Young presents the director's cut of his long-lost, crazy-go-nuts, end-of-the-world musical comedy *HUMAN HIGHWAY*; Keira Knightley and Chloe Grace Moretz are friends at different stages of adolescence in Lynn Shelton's *LAGGIES*; and at Midnight, a young scout and his oblivious troop-mates find themselves at the mercy of a malevolent, unseen enemy in *CUB*.

<http://www.aintitcool.com/node/68619>

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August 12, 2014

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NEWS MOVIES AWARDS TELEVISION BLOGS FILMMAKING MORE



TIFF Adds 'Clouds of Sils Maria' and 'Two Days, One Night,' Reveals 5 More Lineups



By Casey Cipriani | Indiewire
August 12, 2014 at 9:56AM

TIFF has announced additions to its Gala and Special Presentation selections as well as new sets of films that will screen during this year's festival, including a City to City Program with Seoul, South Korea.



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The Toronto International Film Festival has announced new additions to its Gala and Special Presentation selections as well as 5 other all new line ups of films that will screen during this year's festival, which takes place from Sept 4-14 this year.

[READ MORE: Toronto International Film Festival Reveals First Slate of Titles: New Noah Baumbach and Jason Reitman Films Make Cut](#)

TIFF has announced more films in their selection of Gala Films and Special Presentations, which include Olivier Assayas "Clouds of Sils Maria" and the Dardenne's "Two Days, One Night," both of which screened at Cannes in May. This year's TIFF City to City Program highlights works from Seoul, South Korea. The Contemporary World Cinema Program features films from 42 different countries. The International Short Cuts program features short films from 29 different countries. The Future Projections program explores the boundaries between cinema and the visual arts with city-wide installations. The TIFF Cinematheque Program features newly restored classic films from around the world. Finally the Wavelengths Program offers 46 films which challenge conventional approaches to cinema and propose daring new forms of filmic expression. The lineups are listed below in their entirety.

Wednesday, Sept 10

Mark Ruffalo is a manic-depressive stay-at-home dad in the comic drama INFINITELY POLAR BEAR; Viggo Mortensen is a general searching for his runaway daughter through 19th century Patagonia in Argentine auteur Lisandro Alonso's JAUJA; a young British soldier is trapped in the wrong part of Belfast during The Troubles in Yann Demange's '71; flipping the '80s sex comedy formula on its head, a teenager desperately tries to lose his virginity to avoid becoming a human sacrifice in TEEN LUST; a French survivor of the Khmer Rouge reflects back on his imprisonment in the drama THE GATE; a philosophy professor and a small-town hairdresser try to make their impossible relationship work in NOT MY TYPE; INFERNAL AFFAIRS director Andrew Lau co-directs REVENGE OF THE GREEN DRAGONS, a fusion of classic Hong Kong action and gritty New York crime drama executive produced by Martin Scorsese; Neil Young presents the director's cut of his long-lost, crazy-go-nuts, end-of-the-world musical comedy HUMAN HIGHWAY; Keira Knightley and Chloe Grace Moretz are friends at different stages of adolescence in Lynn Shelton's LAGGIES; and at Midnight, a young scout and his oblivious troop-mates find themselves at the mercy of a malevolent, unseen enemy in CUB.

<http://www.indiewire.com/article/toronto-international-film-festival-reveals-7-big-new-lineups-20140812>



August 12, 2014

The Wrap

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Kristen Stewart, Adam Sandler, John Travolta, Arnold Schwarzenegger Movies Headed to Toronto Film Fest

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Festival announces more than 100 additions to its programs

The 2014 Toronto International Film Festival will spotlight films featuring **Kristen Stewart** as an actress' personal assistant, Dustin Hoffman as a choir teacher, **John Travolta** as an art forger, **Adam Sandler** as a shoe repairman, **Arnold Schwarzenegger** as a farmer surrounded by zombies and Benicio del Toro as drug kingpin Pablo Escobar.

Their films were among more than 100 films added to the Toronto lineup on Tuesday, in the fourth of TIFF's weekly programming announcements.

...

The new galas, which join an extensive lineup of previously announced films, include a number of films with notable casts. Maya Forbes' "Infinitely Polar Bear" stars Mark Ruffalo and Zoe Saldana, and Lynn Shelton's "Laggies" features a cast that includes Keira Knightley, Sam Rockwell and Chloe Grace Moretz.

Other galas include Richard Loncraine's "Ruth & Alex," with Diane Keaton and Morgan Freeman; and Cedric Jimenez's "The Connection," with Jean Dujardin.

Special screenings include Sophia Barthes' "Madame Bovary," with Mia Wasikowska and Paul Giamatti; actor-turned-director Paul Bettany's ode to New York films of the '70s, "Shelter"; the Dardenne brothers' "Two Days, One Night," which won raves in Cannes; and Shira Piven's "Welcome to Me," with Kristen Wiig and James Marsden.

Also read: Marion Cotillard Fights Economic Tide in Masterful 'Two Days, One Night'

Also getting a special screening is a new director's cut of "Human Highway," a bizarre 1982 film directed by actor Dean Stockwell and musician Neil Young (under his pseudonym Bernard Shakey).

<http://www.thewrap.com/kristen-stewart-adam-sandler-john-travolta-arnold-schwarzenegger-movies-headed-to-toronto-film-fest/>

